

I'll keep **policy** at the same fullest-reference standard. The family is especially important because **policy** does not always mean 政策: in your passage it is closer to **規定 / 使用政策**, while **insurance policy** is a separate major lexical branch meaning **保單 / 保險合約**. The newest reference's broad-family method is the right model here.

Word family: **policy / policies / policy-making / policymaking / policymaker / policyholder / policy-based**

Base word: policy

Plural: policies

Part of speech: noun (名詞)

Major related/compound forms:

- * policy-making / policymaking
- * policymaker / policy-maker
- * policy decision
- * policy statement
- * policy document
- * policy framework
- * policy objective
- * policy measure
- * policy instrument
- * policy implementation
- * policy reform
- * policy change
- * policy review
- * policyholder — insurance branch
- * policy-based

Major domains:

- * company/organizational policy
- * public policy
- * economic policy
- * monetary policy
- * fiscal policy
- * foreign policy
- * education/health/environmental policy
- * privacy/security/data-retention policy
- * insurance policy
- * computing/security policy
- * reinforcement-learning policy
- * older **policy** = prudence/shrewdness
- * historical U.S. **policy** = illegal lottery — obsolete/specialist

Your sentence:

> “Restaurant chains can introduce clearer seating **policies**...”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **policy** means “a formally adopted rule, principle, or set of guidelines that an organization uses to govern how a recurring situation should be handled”.

The restaurant chain might decide things such as:

- * how long customers may occupy tables;
- * whether tutoring is permitted;
- * whether large groups may use multiple tables;
- * what rules apply during peak periods.

繁體中文：

* **政策**

* **規定**

* **規則**

* **管理方針**

* in this exact context, probably **座位使用規定 / 座位管理政策**

A natural translation is:

> “Restaurant chains can introduce clearer seating policies.”

「連鎖餐廳可以制定更清晰的**座位使用規定 / 座位管理政策**。」

The word does **not** necessarily mean a government policy.

A. POLICY = ADOPTED COURSE OR PRINCIPLE OF ACTION

1. **policy** = an adopted principle or course used to guide decisions (**政策** ; **方針**)

This is the central modern meaning.

Practice 1

> “The company has a clear refund **policy**.”

「公司有清晰的退款**政策 / 規定**。」

Practice 2

> “The school changed its attendance policy.”

「學校修改了出席**規定 / 政策**。」

A policy generally tells people:

> **how an organization intends to deal with a recurring class of situations**

rather than deciding only one isolated case.

2. **a policy = an organization's established way of dealing with something (處理方針)**

Practice 3

> “Our policy is to respond within two working days.”

「我們的**處理方針**是在兩個工作天內回覆。」

Here the policy is expressed as:

> **policy + be + to-infinitive**

3. **company policy = 公司政策 / 公司規定**

Practice 4

> “It is company policy to wear identification badges.”

「佩戴職員證是公司的**規定**。」

In Chinese, **規定** is often more natural than 政策 for mundane workplace rules.

4. **organizational policy = 機構政策 / 方針**

Can guide:

* employees;

* customers;

- * processes;
- * conduct;
- * resource use.

B. EXACT PASSAGE BRANCH: SEATING POLICY

5. **seating policy = rules governing use/allocation of seats (座位使用政策 / 規定) **

Practice 5

> “The café introduced a seating policy during peak hours.”

「咖啡店在繁忙時間引入了**座位使用規定**。」

Possible content might include:

- * time limits;
- * reservation rules;
- * minimum purchases;
- * group seating;
- * table sharing.

The word **policy** itself does not specify which rule has been chosen.

6. **clearer policy = a policy whose expectations/rules are stated more clearly**

Your sentence does not necessarily mean:

> stricter policy.

Clearer means:

> people can more easily understand what is permitted or expected.

A policy can become clearer without becoming harsher.

C. POLICY = SET OF RULES / GUIDELINES WITHIN AN ORGANIZATION

7. **workplace policy = 工作場所政策 / 規定**

Examples:

- * leave policy
- * remote-work policy
- * attendance policy
- * dress policy
- * expenses policy

8. **attendance policy = 出勤 / 出席規定**

> “The course has a strict attendance policy.”

「這門課有嚴格的**出席規定**。」

9. **leave policy = 假期政策 / 請假規定**

Covers matters such as:

- * annual leave;
- * sick leave;
- * request procedure,

depending on organization.

10. **dress policy / dress-code policy = 衣着規定**

11. **travel/expense policy = 差旅 / 費用報銷政策**

Specifies:

- * permitted expenses;
- * approval;
- * reimbursement.

D. CUSTOMER / COMMERCIAL POLICIES

12. **refund policy = 退款政策**

> “Check the store's refund policy before buying.”

「購買前先查看商店的**退款政策**。」

13. **return policy = 退貨政策**

May specify:

- * time window
- * condition of goods
- * proof of purchase
- * refund method

14. **cancellation policy = 取消政策**

Common for:

- * hotels
- * restaurants
- * appointments
- * subscriptions

15. **booking/reservation policy = 預訂政策**

16. **no-show policy = 爽約 / 未到場處理規定**

17. **pricing policy = 定價政策**

A business's general approach to setting prices.

18. **credit policy = 信貸政策**

Business context:

> principles governing when and on what terms customers receive credit.

19. ****customer-service policy = 顧客服務政策****

E. ZERO-TOLERANCE / NO-X POLICIES

20. ****zero-tolerance policy = 零容忍政策****

A policy stating that specified conduct will not be tolerated and may trigger prescribed consequences.

Exact implementation varies by institution.

21. ****no-smoking policy = 禁煙政策 / 規定****

22. ****no-refund policy = 不設退款政策****

23. ****open-door policy — organizational sense****

A management approach encouraging employees to approach management with:

* concerns

* suggestions

* questions.

****繁體中文： ** **開放溝通政策 / 開門政策****

This is distinct from historical/diplomatic uses of ****Open Door Policy****, which depend on the specific historical context.

F. POLICY = PERSONAL PRINCIPLE / USUAL RULE FOR ONESELF

24. **policy = personal principle governing one's own conduct (個人原則) **

Practice 6

> “It is my policy never to lend money to friends.”

「我的一貫**原則**是不借錢給朋友。」

Here there is no institution or government.

25. **make it one's policy to do X = 把做 X 當作一貫原則**

> “She makes it a policy to answer every complaint personally.”

「她一向把親自回覆每宗投訴當作自己的**原則**。」

26. **as a matter of policy = as a regular principle, not a one-off choice (作為一貫政策 / 原則) **

Practice 7

> “We do not comment on individual cases as a matter of policy.”

「按照一貫**政策 / 原則**，我們不評論個別個案。」

G. PUBLIC POLICY

27. **public policy = decisions/principles through which public institutions address social issues (公共政策) **

A broad field covering how public institutions approach issues such as:

- * education;
- * health;
- * transport;
- * housing;
- * environment;
- * economic administration.

Public policy is broader than one individual law.

28. ****policy objective = 政策目標****

The result a policy is intended to achieve.

29. ****policy measure = 政策措施****

A specific action used in pursuit of a policy objective.

30. ****policy instrument = 政策工具****

A mechanism used to pursue an objective, for example:

- * regulation;
- * taxation;
- * subsidy;
- * information provision,

depending on field.

31. ****policy framework = 政策框架****

The larger set of principles/rules within which decisions are made.

32. ****policy agenda = 政策議程****

Set of issues receiving organized policy attention.

33. ****policy option = 政策選項****

A possible course of action available to policymakers.

34. **policy response = 政策回應**

An institutional response to a problem/event.

35. **policy intervention = 政策介入**

A deliberate public/institutional action aimed at affecting an outcome.

H. POLICY MAKING

36. **policymaking / policy-making = process of developing policy (政策制定) **

Practice 8

> “The research may inform policymaking.”

「這項研究可能為**政策制定**提供參考。」

Both:

* **policy-making**

* **policymaking**

occur.

37. **policymaker / policy-maker = person involved in making public/institutional policy (政策制定者) **

> “Researchers presented the findings to policymakers.”

「研究人員向**政策制定者**介紹研究結果。」

38. **policy development = 政策發展 / 制定**

Process of:

* defining issue;

* examining options;

* designing policy.

39. **policy formulation = 政策形成 / 擬定**

More formal public-administration term.

40. **policy implementation = 政策執行**

Putting an adopted policy into practice.

Important distinction:

> policy creation ≠ policy implementation.

41. **policy evaluation = 政策評估**

Assessing effects/performance of a policy.

42. **policy review = 政策檢討**

Re-examining an existing policy.

43. **policy reform = 政策改革**

Substantial change to an existing policy regime.

I. POLICY DECISION

44. **policy decision = decision establishing or reflecting a broader policy (政策決定) **

A policy decision generally concerns:

> what approach should apply systematically,

rather than:

> how one individual case is handled.

45. ****policy vs case-by-case decision****

Example:

> One restaurant asking one group to leave

> = individual decision.

> A chain deciding all tutorial groups are limited to 60 minutes

> = policy.

J. GOVERNMENT / PUBLIC-ADMINISTRATION POLICY CATEGORIES

These are domain compounds of the central meaning.

46. ****economic policy = 經濟政策****

General government/institutional approach to economic conditions.

47. ****fiscal policy = 財政政策****

Policy concerning government:

* expenditure;

* revenue/taxation;

* fiscal balance,

in standard economic usage.

48. ****monetary policy = 貨幣政策****

Policy concerning monetary/financial conditions, generally administered by a monetary authority/central bank within the relevant institutional framework.

49. ****trade policy = 貿易政策****

Approach to international trade.

50. ****industrial policy = 產業政策****

Policy aimed at influencing industrial/economic structure or sectors.

51. ****competition policy = 競爭政策****

Policies/institutions addressing market competition.

52. ****labour / employment policy = 勞工 / 就業政策****

53. ****education policy = 教育政策****

54. ****health policy = 衛生 / 醫療政策****

55. ****housing policy = 房屋政策****

Directly relevant to the broader context behind your passage.

56. ****transport policy = 交通政策****

57. ****environmental policy = 環境政策****

58. ****energy policy = 能源政策****

59. **foreign policy = 外交政策**

Government's general approach to external/international relations.

60. **defence/defense policy = 國防政策**

K. POLICY **ON / TOWARDS / REGARDING**

61. **policy on + issue = 有關某事的政策**

Practice 9

> “The school reviewed its policy on mobile phones.”

「學校檢討了有關手機使用的**政策**。」

Very common.

62. **policy towards/toward + group/issue**

> “The organization changed its policy towards remote work.”

「機構改變了對遙距工作的**方針**。」

63. **policy regarding/concerning X**

More formal:

> policy regarding customer data

= 有關顧客資料的政策.

L. IT / DATA / PRIVACY POLICIES

64. ****privacy policy = 私隱政策****

A statement/document describing how an organization handles personal information.

May address:

- * collection
- * use
- * sharing
- * retention
- * rights

depending on organization/legal framework.

65. ****data-retention policy = 資料保留政策****

Specifies how long particular data is retained and what happens afterward.

66. ****data-handling policy = 資料處理政策****

67. ****acceptable-use policy (AUP) = 可接受使用政策****

Rules governing acceptable use of:

- * networks
- * devices
- * services
- * organizational IT resources.

68. ****password policy = 密碼政策****

May specify:

- * length
- * composition
- * reuse
- * expiration

* authentication practices

depending on system.

69. **security policy = 資訊 / 保安政策**

Broad rules governing security objectives and practices.

70. **access-control policy = 存取控制政策**

Specifies:

> who/what may access which resources under what conditions.

71. **backup policy = 備份政策**

Defines matters such as:

* frequency

* retention

* location

* restoration expectations.

M. POLICY IN COMPUTING / SYSTEM ADMINISTRATION

72. **policy = machine-enforced or administratively defined rule governing system behaviour**

In computing, a **policy** may be more than a prose document: it can be a formal set of rules enforced automatically.

Examples:

* security policy

* network policy

* authorization policy

* resource policy

73. ****policy engine = system evaluating rules and deciding permitted action (政策引擎) ****

A software component that evaluates policy conditions.

74. ****policy enforcement = 政策 / 規則執行****

In computing, this can be automatic.

75. ****policy enforcement point = 政策執行點****

Specialist access-control/security architecture term.

76. ****policy decision point = 政策決策點****

Component that evaluates a request against defined policy in some authorization architectures.

77. ****policy-as-code = 政策即程式碼****

Practice of expressing operational/security/compliance rules in machine-readable/version-controlled form so they can be tested or enforced automatically.

N. GROUP POLICY — COMPUTING

78. ****Group Policy = Windows administrative policy mechanism (群組原則) ****

In Microsoft Windows environments, ****Group Policy**** is a conventional name for centralized configuration/management mechanisms.

The Chinese localization commonly uses:

> ****群組原則****

This is a product/technology term, not the ordinary social meaning alone.

O. NETWORKING

79. **policy-based routing = 基於策略的路由**

Networking technique where routing decisions are made according to configured policy/rules beyond only ordinary destination-based routing.

80. **network policy = 網絡政策 / 網路規則**

Can govern:

- * permitted connections;
- * traffic;
- * segmentation;
- * resource use.

Exact meaning depends on platform.

P. INSURANCE POLICY — MAJOR SEPARATE LEXICAL BRANCH

81. **policy = insurance contract (保單 ; 保險合約) **

This is a major meaning completely different from “organizational policy.”

Practice 10

> “Read the insurance policy carefully.”

「仔細閱讀**保單 / 保險合約**。」

An insurance policy is the contract/document setting out insurance coverage and terms.

Dictionaries treat this as a distinct established sense, historically from a different lexical origin from the governmental/principle sense. ([柯林斯詞典][1])

82. **insurance policy = 保險單 / 保單**

Common types:

- * life insurance policy

- * health insurance policy
- * travel insurance policy
- * home insurance policy
- * motor/auto insurance policy

83. **take out a policy = 購買 / 投保一份保單**

Practice 11

> “She took out a travel insurance policy.”

「她購買了一份旅遊**保險**。」

84. **policyholder = policy owner / person or entity holding policy (保單持有人) **

A **policyholder** is the person/entity that owns or holds the insurance contract.

Depending on policy type:

> policyholder ≠ necessarily insured person ≠ necessarily beneficiary.

85. **policyholder vs insured**

policyholder

holds/owns the policy.

insured

person/property/risk covered under the policy.

They may be the same person, but not necessarily.

86. **policyholder vs beneficiary**

beneficiary

person/entity entitled to receive a specified benefit under applicable policy terms.

Again, not automatically the policyholder.

87. **policy premium = 保費**

The amount paid for insurance coverage.

88. **policy term = 保單有效期**

Period during which the policy is in force, subject to terms.

89. **policy period = 保險期間**

Closely related.

90. **policy limit = 保單賠償限額**

Maximum amount under specified coverage/conditions.

Exact structure can include:

- * per-event limits;

- * aggregate limits;

depending on policy.

91. **policy exclusion = 保單除外責任**

A policy term identifying specified situations/losses outside coverage.

92. **policy condition = 保單條款 / 條件**

93. **policy wording = 保單條文**

Actual contractual wording of the insurance policy.

94. **policy number = 保單編號**

Identifier assigned to the contract.

95. **policy renewal = 保單續保**

96. **policy lapse = 保單失效**

When a policy ceases to remain in force under the relevant terms, often due to nonpayment or another condition depending on insurance type.

97. **policy cancellation = 保單取消**

98. **policy proceeds = 保單給付 / 保險金**

Money payable under a policy, especially in life insurance contexts.

Q. **POLICY LIMITS vs COVERAGE**

99. **coverage = what risks/losses are insured**

while

policy limit

= maximum payable under specified coverage.

A policy can cover a type of loss but still have a monetary limit.

R. REINFORCEMENT LEARNING / AI

100. **policy** = rule/function an agent uses to choose actions (策略)

In reinforcement learning, a **policy** specifies how an agent chooses an action given its state or observation.

A policy may be:

* **deterministic** — selects one action;

* **stochastic** — gives a probability distribution over possible actions. ([Spinning Up][2])

繁體中文 : usually **策略**

This is a major technical sense.

101. **deterministic policy** = 確定性策略

Conceptually:

> state → one selected action.

102. **stochastic policy** = 隨機策略

Conceptually:

> state → probability distribution over actions. ([Spinning Up][2])

103. **optimal policy** = 最佳策略

A policy maximizing the relevant expected return/objective under the model. ([Hugging Face][3])

104. **policy function** = 策略函數

Function implementing the decision rule.

105. ****policy-based method = 基於策略的方法****

RL method that learns/optimizes the policy directly. ([Hugging Face][4])

106. ****policy gradient = 策略梯度****

Family of reinforcement-learning methods that optimize policy parameters using gradient information relating to expected performance.

Specialist machine-learning term.

107. ****policy iteration = 策略迭代****

Dynamic-programming/Markov-decision-process method alternating broadly between:

- * evaluating a policy;

- * improving it,

until convergence under appropriate assumptions.

108. ****behavior policy / behaviour policy = 行為策略****

In off-policy RL terminology:

- > policy used to generate behaviour/data.

109. ****target policy = 目標策略****

Policy being learned/evaluated, which may differ from behavior policy in off-policy methods.

110. ****policy network = 策略網絡****

A neural network parameterizing/representing a policy in deep RL.

S. CONTROL / DECISION THEORY

111. ****policy = decision rule specifying actions under different states (决策策略)****

Related usage appears in:

- * Markov decision processes;
- * operations research;
- * stochastic control;
- * dynamic programming.

The concept is broader than modern deep RL:

> state/information → action/decision.

112. ****stationary policy = 定常策略****

A policy whose decision rule does not explicitly change with time/stage under the relevant model.

113. ****decision policy = 决策策略****

General decision-rule application.

T. POLICY DOCUMENT VS POLICY ITSELF

114. ****policy can mean the rule/principle OR the document recording it****

Compare:

> “The policy requires staff approval.”

= the rule/system.

> “Please send me the policy.”

= often the written policy document.

This metonymic shift is extremely common.

115. **policy document = 政策 / 規章文件**

Formal document setting out the policy.

116. **policy statement = 政策聲明 / 方針聲明**

A concise statement of principles/intended approach.

U. POLICY COMPLIANCE / VIOLATION

117. **comply with a policy = 遵守政策 / 規定**

Practice 12

> “Staff must comply with company policy.”

「員工必須遵守公司的**規定**。」

118. **follow a policy = 遵循政策**

119. **violate / breach a policy = 違反政策 / 規定**

> “Sharing the password violates company policy.”

「分享密碼違反公司的**規定**。」

120. **against policy = 違反規定**

Practice 13

> “That is against company policy.”

「那樣做**違反公司規定**。」

121. ****policy violation = 政策 / 規則違規****

Especially common in:

- * online platforms;
- * workplace compliance;
- * security.

V. ADOPT / INTRODUCE / IMPLEMENT / ENFORCE POLICY

122. ****adopt a policy = formally choose/approve it (採納政策) ****

123. ****introduce a policy = bring the new policy into use (引入政策) ****

This is your exact passage combination.

124. ****implement a policy = put it into practical effect (執行 / 落實政策) ****

125. ****enforce a policy = make sure people comply (執行並強制遵守) ****

These verbs describe different stages.

A useful sequence:

> ****propose → adopt → introduce/implement → enforce → review****

Not every organization uses these steps formally, but semantically the distinctions are useful.

W. CHANGE / REVISE / ABANDON POLICY

126. ****change a policy = 改變政策****

127. ****revise a policy = 修訂政策****

Usually suggests modifying an existing policy.

128. ****update a policy = 更新政策****

Often to reflect:

- * new processes;

- * law;

- * technology;

- * circumstances.

129. ****relax a policy = 放寬政策****

Make restrictions less strict.

130. ****tighten a policy = 收緊政策****

Make standards/restrictions stricter.

131. ****reverse a policy = 政策轉向 / 撤回原政策方向****

Adopt the opposite or substantially different approach.

132. ****abandon / scrap a policy = 放棄 / 取消政策****

133. ****retain a policy = 保留現有政策****

X. POLICY EXCEPTION

134. ****policy exception = 政策例外****

A permitted deviation from the ordinary rule.

135. ****make an exception to policy****

> “Management made an exception to the normal policy.”

「管理層對一般規定作出了****例外安排****。」

136. ****exception policy****

Can refer to rules governing when exceptions are permitted; more domain-specific.

Y. POLICY vs RULE

This is one of the most important distinctions for your passage.

****rule****

usually tells you specifically:

> what you must/must not do.

****policy****

is broader and may state:

- * principles;
- * rules;
- * objectives;
- * decision criteria;
- * expected approach.

Example:

> ****Policy:**** tables should remain available for diners during busy periods.

Specific ****rules**** under it might be:

- * maximum stay 60 minutes;

- * tutoring groups prohibited after 12:00;
- * one table per transaction.

So:

> rule can be part of a policy.

Z. POLICY vs PROCEDURE

policy

= what principle/approach should govern decisions.

procedure

= exact steps people follow.

Example:

> Policy: complaints must be addressed promptly.

> Procedure: record complaint → assign staff member → reply within two days.

AA. POLICY vs GUIDELINE

policy

usually has more institutional authority and expectation of compliance.

guideline

generally offers recommended direction and may allow more discretion.

But organizations use these labels differently.

AB. POLICY vs PROTOCOL

protocol

= defined method/rules for handling a particular process, especially:

- * medicine
- * research
- * technology
- * formal procedure.

policy

= higher-level principle/organizational approach.

A hospital may have:

> infection-control policy

and specific:

> clinical protocols.

AC. POLICY vs LAW

law

= legally binding rule created/recognized by legal authority.

policy

= adopted approach of an organization/government.

A government policy may lead to legislation, but:

> **policy ≠ law**

A restaurant policy is obviously not legislation.

AD. POLICY vs REGULATION

regulation

often refers to a formally binding rule issued under legal/institutional authority.

policy

can be internal or external and may be broader.

A regulation can implement a policy objective.

AE. POLICY vs STRATEGY

policy

= principle/course governing recurring decisions.

strategy

= plan for achieving objectives.

Example:

> Policy: prioritize existing customers during shortages.

> Strategy: expand capacity over two years.

They can interact but are not identical.

AF. POLICY vs PLAN

plan

= intended set of future actions.

policy

= standing approach for making decisions.

A plan may end once completed; a policy normally persists until changed.

AG. POLICY vs PRACTICE

policy

= what an organization says/intends should happen.

practice

= what actually happens.

Very important:

> **policy and practice may differ.**

Example:

> The written policy limits stays to one hour, but in practice staff rarely enforce it.

AH. POLICY vs PRINCIPLE

principle

= fundamental belief/value/rule guiding judgment.

policy

= adopted course arising partly from principles.

One principle can support several policies.

AI. POLICY vs POSITION

position

= stance/opinion on an issue.

policy

= adopted course of action.

Someone may have a position without having authority to create a policy.

AJ. POLICY vs STANDARD

standard

= expected level/specification/criterion.

policy

= rule/course governing action.

Example:

- > security policy
- > password standard.

AK. POLICY vs CODE

code

= organized body of rules/principles.

Examples:

- * code of conduct
- * building code

A code may implement multiple policies.

AL. POLICY vs PROGRAMME/PROGRAM

policy

= governing approach.

programme

= concrete set of activities/resources designed to carry it out.

Example:

- > policy goal: increase access to study space
- > programme: keep community centres open during exam season.

AM. POLICY vs MEASURE

policy

= broader approach.

measure

= specific action.

A policy can consist of several measures.

AN. POLICY vs DECISION

decision

= one choice.

policy

= recurring principle applying across many decisions.

One decision may create a new policy.

AO. POLICY vs CUSTOM

custom/practice

= established way people usually behave.

policy

= deliberately adopted rule/principle.

Something can become customary without ever being formal policy.

AP. **POLICY OF X / POLICY TO DO X**

137. **policy of + -ing/noun**

> "The company follows a policy of transparency."

「公司奉行**透明政策 / 方針**。」

> “a policy of not accepting cash”

「不收現金的政策」

138. **policy is to + verb**

> “Our policy is to reserve these seats for diners.”

「我們的規定是把這些座位預留給用餐顧客。」

139. **policy on + noun**

> policy on seating

= 有關座位使用的政策.

140. **policy towards + noun**

> policy towards late arrivals

= 對遲到者的處理政策.

AQ. COUNTABILITY

policy = one adopted course/rule system

Countable:

> a policy

> several policies

policy as broad governmental field

Can appear without an article:

- > economic policy
- > education policy
- > public policy

Here it refers broadly to a policy domain.

insurance policy

Countable:

- > an insurance policy
- > three policies

AR. OLDER / RARE SENSE: PRUDENCE / EXPEDIENCY

141. **policy = prudent, shrewd, or expedient conduct (權宜 ; 謀略 ; 明智做法) — rare/older**

Older English can use **policy** for:

- * prudence;
- * sagacity;
- * shrewd management;
- * expedient conduct.

For example, dictionaries preserve senses equivalent to “wise or prudent conduct” and “shrewdness.” ([柯林斯詞典][1])

A historical-style example:

- > “It was good policy to avoid unnecessary conflict.”

≈

「避免不必要衝突是**明智 / 權宜之策**。」

Modern English would more commonly say:

- * wise
- * prudent
- * sensible

* good strategy

rather than use bare **policy** this way.

142. **policy** = political wisdom/cunning — rare

A still rarer historical sense:

> political shrewdness/cunning.

Database priority: low/archaic. ([柯林斯詞典][1])

AS. OBSOLETE: GOVERNMENT / POLITY

143. **policy** = government/polity — obsolete

Historically, **policy** could refer to:

> government/civil administration/polity.

This is no longer a normal modern sense. ([柯林斯詞典][1])

AT. HISTORICAL U.S. **POLICY** LOTTERY

144. **policy** = an illegal numbers lottery — historical U.S.

Older American usage had **policy** for an illegal lottery/“numbers” gambling game. Dictionaries still record this historical U.S. sense. ([柯林斯詞典][5])

Related historical expressions can include:

* policy game

* policy shop

* policy player

Database priority: historical/very low.

This sense is unrelated in modern interpretation to:

> government policy

or:

> insurance policy.

AU. FAMILY MAP

Family member / branch	Main modern meanings
-----	-----
policy — organizational	adopted rule/principle/course guiding recurring decisions
policy — personal	standing principle a person follows
policy — public	governmental/institutional approach to public issues
policy — document	written statement containing policy
policy — insurance	insurance contract / policy document
policy — computing	defined rule set governing system access/behaviour
policy — RL/decision theory	rule/function mapping states or observations to actions
policies	plural of all relevant countable senses
policymaking	development/formulation of policy
policymaker	person involved in policy formulation
policyholder	holder/owner of an insurance policy
policy-based	determined/governed according to policy
policy — older	prudence/shrewdness/expediency
policy — historical U.S.	illegal numbers lottery

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
policy — general	機構 / 個人為處理一類反覆出現的問題而採用的原則、規定或方針
company policy	公司正式採用的內部規定 / 方針
seating policy	管理座位分配、使用時間、資格等的座位使用規定
attendance policy	有關出勤 / 出席要求的政策或規定
refund/return policy	顧客在甚麼條件下可退款 / 退貨的規定
cancellation policy	取消預訂 / 服務時適用的規定
zero-tolerance policy	對指定行為不予容忍並按政策處理的零容忍政策
personal policy	個人一向遵守的行事原則
as a matter of policy	因一貫政策 / 原則，而非某一次臨時決定
public policy	公共機構處理社會 / 經濟問題所採取的整體政策方向
policy objective	政策希望達成的目標
policy measure	為實現政策目標而採取的具體措施
policy instrument	稅收、規管、補貼等用以實現政策目標的工具
policy framework	制定具體決策時依循的整體政策框架
policymaking	政策形成、設計和制定的過程

policymaker	參與制定政策的人員	
policy implementation	把已採納政策真正落實執行	
policy evaluation	評估政策效果 / 表現	
economic/fiscal/monetary policy	經濟 / 財政 / 貨幣政策	
foreign policy	政府處理對外關係的外交政策	
policy on X	有關 X 的政策	
privacy policy	機構說明如何處理個人資料的私隱政策	
acceptable-use policy	規定資訊系統 / 網絡可接受使用方式的政策	
security policy	組織在資訊 / 實體安全方面遵循的高層規則與原則	
access-control policy	決定誰可在甚麼條件下存取何種資源的規則	
policy engine	以機器規則評估請求並作出政策判斷的軟件元件	
policy-as-code	以可版本管理 / 自動執行的程式化形式表達政策	
Group Policy	Windows 管理環境中的「群組原則」機制	
policy-based routing	根據配置策略而非僅目的地址作路由選擇	
insurance policy	列明保險保障、條款與責任的保單 / 保險合約	
policyholder	持有 / 擁有保單的個人或實體	
policy premium	保費	
policy term/period	保單有效期間	
policy limit	某項保障的最高賠付 / 責任限額	
policy exclusion	明確排除在保障範圍之外的情況	
policy wording	保單實際合約條文	
policy renewal/lapse	保單續保 / 失效	
policy — reinforcement learning	智能體根據狀態 / 觀察選擇行動的策略函數	
deterministic policy	對某狀態指定單一行動的確定性策略	
stochastic policy	對可能行動給出概率分布的隨機策略	
optimal policy	在模型目標下令期望回報最大的最佳策略	
policy gradient	直接優化策略參數的一類強化學習方法	
policy iteration	交替評估和改進策略的策略迭代方法	
behavior/target policy	離策略強化學習中的行為策略 / 目標策略	
adopt a policy	正式選定 / 批准一項政策	
introduce a policy	把新政策正式帶入實際使用	
implement a policy	把政策內容實際落實	
enforce a policy	要求人員實際遵守政策並執行後果	
revise/update policy	修訂 / 更新現有政策	
relax/tighten policy	放寬 / 收緊政策要求	
policy exception	對一般政策規則獲准作出的例外	
policy — old prudence sense	明智 / 權宜的行事方式；現已罕見	
policy — historical lottery	美國歷史用語中的非法數字彩票；非常低頻	

For your original sentence

> “Restaurant chains can introduce clearer seating ****policies****...”

The exact meaning is:

****policies** = 餐廳連鎖集團預先制定、用來統一處理座位使用問題的一套管理原則和規定

So the author is suggesting something broader than employees making ad-hoc decisions every time.

For example:

- > Tutor A sits for three hours → one employee asks them to leave
- > Tutor B does the same tomorrow → another employee allows it

is merely inconsistent case-by-case practice.

A **seating policy** would instead establish a repeatable approach, such as:

> what kinds of use are permitted, how long customers may stay, and what staff should do when tables are needed.

A particularly important distinction is therefore:

> **policy**

> = 「我們一貫如何處理這類情況」

> **rule**

> = 「你具體必須 / 不得做甚麼」

> **procedure**

> = 「員工實際應按甚麼步驟處理」

For the core database, I would keep **5 principal semantic branches**:

1. **an adopted organizational or personal principle/course governing recurring decisions**
2. **government/public-policy course or framework**
3. **the written document stating such rules/principles**
4. **insurance policy = insurance contract**
5. **technical decision rule in computing, control theory, and reinforcement learning**

Then separately index **polycymaking, polycymaker, policyholder, privacy/security/access policies, policy-as-code, policy-based routing, deterministic/stochastic RL policy**, plus the rare historical **prudence/shrewdness** and **U.S. lottery** senses rather than silently dropping them.

[1]: https://www.collinsdictionary.com/dictionary/english/policy?utm_source=chatgpt.com "POLICY definition and meaning | Collins English Dictionary"

[2]: https://spinningup.openai.com/en/latest/spinningup/rl_intro.html?utm_source=chatgpt.com "Part 1: Key Concepts in RL — Spinning Up documentation"

[3]: https://huggingface.co/learn/deep-rl-course/en/unit1/glossary?utm_source=chatgpt.com "Glossary · Hugging Face"

[4]: https://huggingface.co/learn/deep-rl-course/en/unit1/two-methods?utm_source=chatgpt.com

"Two main approaches for solving RL problems · Hugging Face"

[5]: https://www.collinsdictionary.com/us/dictionary/english/policy?utm_source=chatgpt.com

"POLICY definition in American English | Collins English Dictionary"